

Student Guide — primary / module-02- panchabhuta

IKS Curriculum

Table of Contents

Student Workbook

My Five Friends Drawing Book — Primary

My name: _____ **Class:** _____

Draw a lot. Write a little. Bring this book to every class.

Day 1 — Meet the Five Friends



Pr̥thvī (earth) — draw something solid:



Ap (water) — draw something wet:



Tejas (fire / warmth) — draw something warm:



Vāyu (air / wind) — draw something flowing:



Ākāśa (space) — draw an empty place:

Day 2 — Earth and Water

Three Pr̥thvī things in my home: 1. _____ 2. _____ 3. _____

Three Ap things in my home: 1. _____ 2. _____ 3. _____

Day 3 — Fire and Air

Something Tejas I noticed today: _____

Something Vāyu I noticed today: _____

Day 4 — Space

The biggest Ākāśa at home is in: _____

(Draw it on the next page.)

Day 5 — The Song

Today we sing!

Pr̥thvī, ap, tejas, vāyu, ākāśa
Five great friends are everywhere
Earth and water, fire and air,
And the space that's everywhere.

I sang it ____ times today. (Tick a star for each: ★★☆☆)

Day 6 — Sort It

The trickiest object I sorted today: _____

It was tricky because: _____

Day 7 — Element Walk

I walked at school and saw: _____

The element that was too much / missing: _____

(Draw what I saw)

Days 8–9 — My Project

My element: _____

What I'm making: _____

Day 10 — Show and Tell

I showed my project! 🌟 (sticker)

I told about _____ (element name)

The Glossary

Sanskrit	What it means
pr̥thvī	earth, solid things
ap	water, liquid things
tejas	fire, warmth, light
vāyu	air, wind
ākāśa	space, empty place
pañcabhūta	“five great elements”

Day 1 — Five Friends Story

Module: Panchabhūta (Primary) · **Time:** 35 min

Goal

Children meet the five elements through a story and a touch-station, and can name at least three by end of class.

Materials

- 5 sample objects: rock, water in a clear jar, candle (unlit), balloon, empty box
- Drawing paper + crayons

The flow

Settle + chant (5 min)

Sit on the mat. Teacher: “*We’re starting something new. For the next two weeks we’ll meet **five friends**.*”

Teach the chant (3 times: soft / normal / loud, clap on each name):

pr̥thvī, ap, tejas, vāyu, ākāśa Earth, water, fire, air, space!

Story (10 min)

The Five Friends

Once there were five friends. Each one was made of something different.

The first friend was **Pr̥thvī**. She was made of **earth**. She was solid and steady. You could stand on her, build a house on her, plant a seed in her. (Hold up the rock.)

The second friend was **Ap**. He was made of **water**. He flowed and changed shape. He could fill any cup, any bottle, any pond. (Hold up the water jar.)

The third friend was **Tejas**. He was made of **fire**. He gave warmth and light. The sun is his big brother. (Hold up the candle — “*this would be Tejas if we lit it*”.)

The fourth friend was **Vāyu**. She was made of **air**. She moved invisibly. When she ran past you, you felt a breeze. (Hold up the balloon.)

The fifth friend was **Ākāśa**. She was made of **space**. She didn’t have a shape or colour. She was where all the other friends lived. (Hold up the empty box — “*look — Ākāśa is INSIDE the box, where there’s nothing.*”)

All five friends were everywhere — in this room, in your home, even inside your body. Today we’ll go meet them.

Touch + see (10 min)

Set the 5 objects out. Children go in pairs to each object, look and touch (where safe), and chorus the name as they touch.

Draw (8 min)

Each child draws ONE element (their favourite) on paper. Write the Sanskrit name at the top (teacher helps spell).

Show + chant (2 min)

3 children hold up their drawings. Class chants the name of that element.

End with the daily chant once.

Homework / take-home

- At home tonight: find ONE thing for each of the five elements. Bring one of them to class tomorrow (small enough to fit in your pocket or a small bag).

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** Draw all five elements on one page.
- **Tier down:** Just remember three names — *pr̥thvī*, *ap*, *vāyu*. The other two can come later this week.

Teacher’s quick notes

- Sing the chant slowly the first time. Speed up over the week.
- Some children will laugh at “Ākāśa is empty space.” That’s fine. The laugh helps it stick.

Day 2 — Earth and Water

Module: Panchabhūta (Primary) · **Time:** 35 min

Goal

Children explore *prthvī* and *ap* through touching, sorting, and drawing.

Materials

- Bring-from-home objects (each child has 1)
- A bowl of soil, a bowl of small pebbles, a jug of water, a sponge
- Drawing paper

The flow

Settle + chant (5 min)

Daily chant: *prthvī, ap, tejas, vāyu, ākāśa* — 3 times, clapping.

Story — recall (3 min)

“Yesterday we met five friends. Who can name them?” — chorus.

“Today we meet two of them more closely: Prthvī and Ap.”

Touch station: Earth (7 min)

- Show the bowl of soil and the bowl of pebbles. Pass them around.
- Question: *“What does Prthvī feel like?”* (Hard. Soft. Cold. Rough. Smooth.)
- Together: *“All solid things are part of Prthvī. The floor is Prthvī. Your desk is Prthvī. Your bones are Prthvī.”*

Touch station: Water (7 min)

- Show the jug. Pour a little into a bowl. Show the sponge soaking it up.
- Question: *“What does Ap feel like?”* (Wet. Cold. Flowing. Soft.)
- Together: *“All liquid things are part of Ap. Your tears are Ap. The river is Ap. Milk is Ap.”*

Draw (10 min)

Each child folds a paper in half. Left side: 3 things that are mostly Prthvī. Right side: 3 things that are mostly Ap.

Show + chant (3 min)

2 children hold up their drawings. Class names one Prthvī thing and one Ap thing.

Close with the chant.

Homework / take-home

- Tomorrow bring: ONE thing that gives warmth or light (a candle? a torch? a picture of the sun?).

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** Find one thing that is BOTH Pṛthvī AND Ap (a sponge with water? a wet rock?). Draw it on the back.
- **Tier down:** Just sort the bring-from-home objects into 2 piles — solid or liquid. Drawing optional.

Teacher's quick notes

- The sponge demonstration (“water inside something solid”) is great for showing that real things often have *more than one* element.
- A child may say “my bones are not in the floor!” — agree, explain “Pṛthvī isn’t just the *floor* — it’s all solid stuff, including your bones, your hair, your fingernails.”

Day 3 — Fire and Air

Module: Panchabhūta (Primary) · **Time:** 35 min

Goal

Children explore *tejas* and *vāyu* through warmth, breeze, and drawing.

Materials

- Sunlight through a window (if possible) OR a tube light / desk lamp
- One or two balloons
- A small handheld paper fan (or each child folds one)
- Drawing paper

The flow

Settle + chant (5 min)

Daily chant.

Story — recall (3 min)

“Who remembers our five friends?” — chorus all five. “Yesterday we met Pṛthvī and Ap. Today: Tejas and Vāyu.”

Feel station: Fire/warmth (7 min)

- Take children to a sunny window or under a warm tube light.
- “Put your hand up. What do you feel?” (Warm.)

- *“That warmth is Tejas. The sun gives us Tejas. A candle gives us Tejas. Your body makes a little Tejas — touch your hand to your cheek.”*
- *“Tejas is also what cooks our food. Tejas is what helps us digest. Tejas is everywhere there is heat or light.”*

(No actual flame in class. Children’s bring-from-home objects — torches, candle pictures — can be shared.)

Feel station: Air (7 min)

- Show a balloon. Inflate and release; watch it fly.
- *“What was inside the balloon?”* (Air.)
- Give each child a fan (or make one from paper).
- Fan their own face. *“That’s Vāyu. When the wind blows your hair, that’s Vāyu. When you breathe in, that’s Vāyu coming inside you.”*
- *“Everything that flows and is invisible — that’s Vāyu.”*

Draw (10 min)

Each child draws: - TOP: one Tejas thing they like. - BOTTOM: one Vāyu thing they like.

Show + chant (3 min)

2 shares. Daily chant to close.

Homework / take-home

- Tomorrow: notice the **empty space** in your bedroom. How big is it? Can you fit your arms inside without touching anything?

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** Why is the sun TOO MUCH Tejas in summer? Why is wind TOO MUCH Vāyu during a storm?
- **Tier down:** Just remember: Tejas = warmth/light, Vāyu = air/wind.

Teacher’s quick notes

- For the fire station: NO actual flames. Children’s torches/lamps are safe. Body warmth (touching one’s own hand) is the most reliable demo.
- Some children will giggle when they feel a breeze on their face. Let them giggle — surprise is good for memory.

Day 4 — Space, the Quiet Friend

Module: Panchabhūta (Primary) · **Time:** 35 min

Goal

Children notice *ākāśa* — the element that has no shape, colour, or smell — by exploring empty space.

Materials

- An empty cardboard box, lid removed
- An empty cup
- A doorway or wide-open area
- Drawing paper

The flow

Settle + chant (5 min)

Daily chant. By now the chant should be fluid.

Story — recall (3 min)

“Who remembers all five friends?” — chorus. “Today: Ākāśa. She’s the quietest friend. She doesn’t have a shape. She doesn’t have a colour. But she’s the friend who lets everyone else exist.”

The Empty Box game (8 min)

- Hold up the cardboard box, lid off. *“What’s in this box?”*
- Children: *“Nothing!” “Air!”*
- *“You’re right that there’s air — but there’s also something else. The SPACE inside the box. The room. The gap. That’s Ākāśa.”*
- Pass the box around. Each child holds it and looks INSIDE the box. *“What do you see?”*
- *“Now look at this cup. The cup is Pṛthvī. The inside of the cup, where the tea will go — that’s Ākāśa.”*

Notice game (7 min)

- Children stand up.
- *“Hold your arms out. The gap between your arms — that’s Ākāśa.”*
- *“Look between you and the person next to you. That gap — that’s Ākāśa.”*
- *“Look up at the ceiling. The gap between your head and the ceiling — that’s Ākāśa.”*
- *“Ākāśa is everywhere there’s room for something else to be.”*

Sound demonstration (5 min)

- *“Ākāśa has one special thing — sound travels through it.”*
- Clap once, loudly. *“That clap travelled through Ākāśa to your ears.”*

- “That’s why old Indian thinkers said Ākāśa’s quality is **sound** (śabda).”

Draw (5 min)

Each child draws a place at home where they notice Ākāśa most. (The space under their bed? The empty room when no one’s there? The sky?)

Show + chant (2 min)

2 shares. Chant to close.

Homework

- Tomorrow we sing! Practise the chant at home with a parent or sibling.

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** Can you think of a place where there’s NO Ākāśa? (Trick question — even inside the densest rock, there’s a tiny bit of space between atoms. But that’s a Grade 6+ idea.)
- **Tier down:** Just remember: Ākāśa = the empty room where everything else lives.

Teacher’s quick notes

- This is the hardest day at this band — empty space is an abstract idea. The cardboard-box and arm-gap demos are essential.
- Some children will be confused: “but air is in the box too!” — that’s fine. “Yes! Vāyu and Ākāśa are both there. They’re friends — they overlap a lot.”

Day 5 — Five-Element Song

Module: Panchabhūta (Primary) · **Time:** 35 min

Goal

Children memorise all five names (Sanskrit + English) through a song they can sing in chorus.

Materials

- (Optional) A simple drum or clapper for rhythm
- Five large picture cards (one per element)

The flow

Settle + chant (3 min)

Daily chant — by now flying.

Song (10 min)

Teach a simple tune to the chant. Suggested tune: “Twinkle Twinkle Little Star” (any familiar nursery tune works).

Verse 1: > *Ṙṛthvī, ap, tejas, vāyu, ākāśa* > *Five great friends are everywhere* > *Earth and water, fire and air,* > *And the space that’s everywhere.*

Verse 2 (optional, slightly older children): > *Ṙṛthvī holds us, ap flows free,* > *Tejas warms us, vāyu’s breeze,* > *Ākāśa makes the room for all,* > *Five friends standing tall.*

Sing 3 times. Add claps on the Sanskrit names.

Recall game (10 min)

Hold up each picture card. Class chants the Sanskrit name.

Then turn the card face-down. Class chants the Sanskrit name from memory.

Then mix the order. Class chants whichever name you point to.

Drawing / quiet time (10 min)

Each child completes a drawing book entry: - 5 small boxes on one page. - One element name in each box (teacher helps). - One small picture in each box.

Show + chant (2 min)

Hold up the best drawings (without ranking). Close with the song.

Homework

- Tomorrow we sort! Bring 2 small objects from home — anything safe and small.

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** Make up a Verse 3 of the song with your own examples.
- **Tier down:** Sing along — don’t worry if the words aren’t perfect yet.

Teacher’s quick notes

- The song is *the* memory tool of this module. Sing it at every opportunity for the rest of the year.
- If a child won’t sing, let them clap the rhythm instead.

Day 6 — Sort It (Big Activity Day)

Module: Panchabhūta (Primary) · **Time:** 35 min

Goal

Children sort 15+ everyday objects into the five-element trays in pairs.

Materials

- 5 large trays (or baskets) labelled with element name + picture
- Children's bring-from-home objects (2 each = ~30+)
- 3 teacher-supplied mystery objects per pair (e.g. crayon, spoon, paper boat)
- Sticker reward chart (optional)

The flow

Settle + chant + song (5 min)

Daily chant + the song from Day 5.

Sort game (20 min)

- Children work in pairs. Each pair has ~5 objects.
- They place each object on the right tray.
- For each object they say aloud (in their own words): *"This is mostly Pṛthvī because it's solid."*

After 10 min of sorting, do a class **gallery walk**: pairs walk around to see how other pairs sorted. If they disagree, they can move the object — but the original pair gets to defend it.

Group portrait (8 min)

- The class gathers around the trays.
- Children draw a "group portrait" — a picture of all 5 trays with the objects on them.

Show + chant (2 min)

Close with the song.

Homework

- Tomorrow we go for a walk! Wear shoes you can walk in.

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** Pick the one object that fits THREE elements at once. Explain to a friend.
- **Tier down:** Sort just 3 objects today. The other children can help.

Teacher's quick notes

- Disagreements during the gallery walk are GOOD. Don't resolve them — let children argue. If they ask the teacher to decide, redirect: *"Tell me both sides. I think you're both right in different ways."*
- This is the most fun day of the module. Expect noise. Embrace it.

Day 7 — Find an Imbalance

Module: Panchabhūta (Primary) · **Time:** 35 min (10 min outside)

Goal

Children walk around the school grounds and find one place where an element is “too much” or “missing.” They draw and tell the class about it.

Materials

- Drawing paper + clipboards (or hard surfaces)
- Crayons
- Adult supervisor accompanying the walk

The flow

Settle + chant + song (5 min)

Daily chant + song.

Story — what is imbalance? (5 min)

- *“Sometimes one of our five friends is too much, or one is missing. When that happens, the others suffer.”*
- Examples (with simple drawings on the board):
 - Too much Vāyu = a strong wind storm. Trees fall.
 - Too little Ap = no rain. Plants die.
 - Too much Pṛthvī of the wrong kind = a pile of plastic waste. Smelly.
 - Too noisy Ākāśa = traffic horn outside the school. We can’t sleep or study.

The walk (10 min)

- Walk around the school grounds in a single line. Adult at the front and back.
- Children carry clipboard + paper.
- Look for ONE place where they think an element is too much or missing.

Draw + share (12 min)

- Back in the classroom.
- Each child draws what they saw and writes ONE sentence (teacher helps): *“There is too much / too little _____ at _____.”*
- Quick share: 4 children show their drawings.

Show + chant (3 min)

Close with chant.

Homework

- Tomorrow we start projects. Think: which ONE element do you want to work on?

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** Think of ONE small thing your class could do to help (pick up a piece of trash, plant a seed, save water at the tap).
- **Tier down:** Pick any element. The “imbalance” can be simply “I saw a lot of ____ today” without judgement.

Teacher’s quick notes

- Don’t let this become depressing. Every child should also notice ONE place where the elements are in good balance (a healthy tree, clean water, a quiet corner).
- For schools in a tough environment, focus the walk on the school grounds and ONE specific issue (e.g. litter). Don’t try to cover everything.

Day 8 — Project Day 1

Module: Panchabhūta (Primary) · **Time:** 35 min

Goal

Each child picks ONE element and starts a project (drawing, 3D model, or story).

Materials

- Drawing paper, crayons, scissors, glue, recycled materials (newspaper, cardboard, fabric scraps)
- Clay or play-dough for 3D models
- Audio recorder (optional) for story-tellers

The flow

Settle + chant + song (5 min)

Project choice (5 min)

- Each child picks ONE element.
- Each child picks ONE format:
 - **Drawing** — a big picture of the element with one example from home
 - **3D model** — clay, recycled junk, etc.
 - **Story** — a 30-second spoken story about the element
- Quick check: every child has decided.

Project work (22 min)

- Children work individually or in twos at desks.

- Teacher rotates: 30 seconds per child, asking ONE question: “*What part of this is your favourite?*”

Show + chant (3 min)

2 children share progress. Close with the song.

Homework

- Finish any drawing/model at home if you didn’t finish in class. Story-tellers practise your story 3 times.

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** Show two elements interacting (rain falling on soil = Ap + Pṛthvī).
- **Tier down:** Drawing is the easiest format. Just pick one element and one picture.

Teacher’s quick notes

- Some children will get stuck on “what to draw.” Offer a one-sentence prompt: “*Draw your favourite Pṛthvī thing at home.*”
- Watch for materials disputes — keep clay and glue stations supervised.

Day 9 — Project Day 2

Module: Panchabhūta (Primary) · **Time:** 35 min

Goal

Each child finishes their project and practises their 30-second show-and-tell.

Materials

- All in-progress materials
- Story-tellers’ notes (optional)

The flow

Settle + chant + song (5 min)

Finish + practise (25 min)

- **First 15 min: finish.** Children complete drawings, models, or stories.
- **Last 10 min: practise.** Children rehearse their 30-sec show-and-tell with a partner. The partner listens for: did they say the element name? Did they show one example from home?

Show + chant (5 min)

2 volunteers share their final piece. Class chants the element name in response.

Homework

- Bring your project tomorrow! Practise telling about it one more time.

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** Practise your show-and-tell with three different listeners — get three pieces of feedback.
- **Tier down:** Just one practice with the teacher.

Teacher's quick notes

- Some children will have lost or forgotten their work-in-progress. Have spare materials ready to remake quickly.
- The 30-second show-and-tell is the FOCUSED skill of Day 10. Practise the timing today.

Day 10 — Show + Tell

Module: Panchabhūta (Primary) · **Time:** 35 min

Goal

Each child stands up, shows their project, and tells about it for 30 seconds. They get a sticker.

Materials

- All children's projects
- Stickers (one per child)
- Bell or chime to gently signal 30 seconds

The flow

Settle + chant + song (5 min)

The biggest, loudest singing of the chant. *“This is the last day we’ll meet the five friends together. Sing big!”*

Show + tell (25 min — most of the class)

- 1 child at a time. 30 seconds. Chime when time's up.
- Each child says (with teacher's prompting if needed):
 1. The element name.
 2. What their project shows.
 3. One example from home.
- Class claps. Child gets a sticker.

With ~25 children in 25 minutes, plan tight pacing. If you have more children, split across two days OR pair them up.

Closing ceremony (5 min)

- Whole class stands.
- Final chant — biggest yet.
- Teacher: “*You all met the five friends. They live with you now.*”

Homework

- None. Module done.

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** A child who’s confident can give a 45-sec show-and-tell with an extra detail.
- **Tier down:** Shy child sits next to the teacher; teacher describes the project for them.

Teacher’s quick notes

- The 30-second cap is for everyone, including the chatty ones. The chime helps.
- This is a celebration day. No “constructive feedback” — only stickers and applause.
- Take a class photo of all the projects laid out. Send to parents.